

Proposal — RFP No. 550575, Media Relation Services

City of Detroit, Office of Contracting and Procurement · for the City Council office of Councilwoman Johnson, District 4 · submitted by Integrated Efficiency Business Consultants (IEBC)

Oct 5, 2026 · @marcus

Before you submit (internal — delete this section)

This RFP closed on **September 30, 2026 at 3:00 PM EST**, and the City does not accept late or emailed proposals (RFP cover page and section 4.5). Unless the deadline was extended, this proposal can't be submitted to RFP 550575.

- ☐ **Check EUNA Bonfire today** (detroit.bonfirehub.com, RFP 550575) for an addendum that extended the due date. If there isn't one, keep this proposal ready for a re-issue or the next Council office communications RFP. Shekia Sewell is the buyer.
- ☐ **Minimum qualification (section 3.1):** "a minimum of five (5) years of experience providing the services requested" on projects of similar scope. IEBC began in 2025. Mark's in-house marketing at Northwest Ticket since 2001 may not count, because the RFP asks for services provided to others. The safest route is to **team with an established Detroit marketing or design firm (5+ years) as a joint venture** or as prime. That also earns +2 Joint Venture equalization points.
- ☐ **The scope is hands-on production for one council office**, not a three-year media plan. It covers Councilwoman Johnson's District 4 newsletter, flyers, calendar, promotional items, social posts, e-blasts, PR statements and talking points, with design, editing, print vendor coordination, and attending district events. The proposal below is rewritten for that.
- ☐ **Know her brand.** The City wants knowledge of "CWJ's brand, her priorities, and her position on matters important to District 4." Study her newsletters, social accounts and Council record, and fill section B2's [brackets] with real examples.
- ☐ **Scoring:** qualifications and experience 50, marketing strategy 25, price 25. Experience is half the score, so the references and partner resumes matter most.
- ☐ **Detroit equalization credits (up to 10 points):** Detroit Headquartered 5, Detroit Resident Business 5, Detroit Micro Business 2. They count only with valid **CRIO certificates uploaded with the bid**. Apply through the City's Civil Rights, Inclusion &

Opportunity office.

- ☐ **Upload in Bonfire:** Attachments A, B and C; D1 (Certificate of Authority, Non-Collusion Affidavit, Affidavit of Disclosure of Interests, notarized where marked); and agreement to the model contract (E) or listed exceptions. D2 forms and insurance are due only if awarded.
- ☐ **Fix the inconsistencies:** one phone number on every form (the resume says 661.466.9932; the cover letter says 206.850.5327). Don't attach the job-application cover letter.
- ☐ **Fill every [bracket].**

RFP 550575 at a glance (internal)

Item	What the RFP says
Title / number	Media Relation Services, RFP No. 550575 (revised 08/21/2026)
For	City Council department: Councilwoman Johnson's team, District 4, as needed
Buyer	Shekia Sewell, Office of Contracting and Procurement
Dates	Advertised September 10 · questions due September 14, 3:00 PM · answers September 16 · proposals due September 30, 2026, 3:00 PM EST
Submit	EUNA Bonfire only (detroit.bonfirehub.com); signed in the portal by an officer who can bind the company
Term / award	3-year Professional Services Contract; one or multiple awards; renewals need Council approval
Minimum qualification	5 years providing these services on projects of similar scope and size
Scoring	Qualifications and experience 50 · marketing strategy 25 · price 25 · plus up to 10 Detroit equalization points

Item	What the RFP says
Bonus	Meeting the City data standards (section 2.3) is "factored positively"
Price	Firm, not-to-exceed cost proposal on Attachment C, with a fee schedule or hourly rates by staff type
Payment	Net 30 from invoice receipt; invoices through the City's Oracle vendor portal
AI	Allowed and encouraged if used ethically; must disclose (Attachment A, item r) and explain how it works

The work (section 2.1):

- **Print and mailed:** district newsletter (multi-page, recurring) and its digital version, yearly calendar, flyers
- **Promotional and branded:** fridge magnets, table throws, stand-up banners, yard signs, vehicle wraps
- **Digital and social:** social media and e-blast content
- **PR:** messaging statements, talking points
- **Events:** handout brochures
- **Process:** content gathering and drafting, design and layout, editing and proofreading, review cycles with staff and leadership, print vendor coordination, QR code and link audits before print
- **Also:** brand stewardship, multi-format adaptation, media campaigns, attending major district programs, and strategic input. Experience with elected officials and local media is preferred.

Attachment A — Respondent Questionnaire

Part 1. Respondent experience and organization

Single point of contact for the RFP / partner or manager in charge (the same person)

Item	Response
Name	Mark Odom
Title	Founder & CEO
Address	[street], Detroit, MI 48219
E-mail	[business email]
Phone number	[one number, the same on every form]

Respondent background

Item	Response
Full legal business name	[Integrated Efficiency Business Consultants, LLC — exact name on the state filing]
Principal place of business / place of performance	[street], Detroit, MI 48219; work performed in Detroit and on site at District 4 programs
Business entity designation	[LLC / Inc. / sole proprietor]
Tax status and FEIN	[]
State formed in	Michigan
Company phone	[]
Website	[]
Years in business	[IEBC since 2025; founder's marketing and sales leadership since 2001 — see the internal note on the 5-year minimum]
Average employees, each of the last 3 years	[]
Detroit residents employed now	[]
Detroit residents on this project if awarded	[]
New hires projected if awarded	[]
Willing to sign a Priority Hire Agreement with Detroit at Work?	Yes

Item	Response
Credentials / training for new hires	Brand and style-guide training, accessibility and plain-language writing, print production and proofing standards, and data privacy
City of Detroit contracts, last 5 years	[None / list]
Claims or lawsuits from services, last 10 years	[None / list]
Contracts terminated	[None / list]
q. Interested parties debarred or suspended	[None]
r. Does the solution use Artificial Intelligence, or will it within 5 years?	Yes. AI helps draft first versions, adapt one approved piece to print, email and social formats, check spelling and broken links, and organize content from staff. A person on our team reviews and edits everything, and nothing is published without the Councilwoman's office's approval. We don't put residents' personal information into AI tools. See B4 for how it works.

Prior experience (three references, last 5 years)

The City wants three projects "of similar size and scope": a recurring newsletter, print and promotional pieces, social content and PR for an organization, ideally an elected official or public body. Use the partner firm's projects where IEBC's own don't fit, and name who did the work.

Field	Reference 1	Reference 2	Reference 3
Company name	[]	[]	[]
Project name / title	[]	[]	[]
Client location	[]	[]	[]
Contact name, title	[]	[]	[]
Contact phone and e-mail	[]	[]	[]

Field	Reference 1	Reference 2	Reference 3
Dates of service (mm/yy – mm/yy)	[]	[]	[]
Services and why they're similar in size and scope	[newsletter issues per year, print runs, social content, PR]	[]	[]
Key personnel	[]	[]	[]

Subcontractors

Question	Response
Will subcontractors be used?	Yes. [Partner firm name and address] provides graphic design and print production management. [Print vendor name] prints and produces promotional items.
Checked against the City's debarred and suspended list?	Yes — [date checked]
Percentage of work by subcontractor	[]% (CRIO-certified Detroit subcontractors add equalization points in proportion to their share)
Similar projects completed together	[number and short description]

Complete the Subcontractor Reference Form (one project from the last 5 years) for each subcontractor.

Part 2. Capacity and staffing

One account lead is the Councilwoman's office's single contact. A designer, a writer and editor, and a print coordinator sit behind that lead, and the print vendor works under it. [Attach an organization chart and a resume for each person.]

Role	Name	Responsibility	Time on this account
Account lead / strategist	Mark Odom	Office contact; brand stewardship; messaging, PR statements and talking points; campaign strategy; review-cycle management; attends major district programs	[] hours/month
Senior graphic designer	[]	Newsletter, calendar, flyers, brochures, promotional items, banners, signs, vehicle wrap; brand consistency	[]
Writer / editor	[]	Content gathering from Policy Analysts, Community Liaisons and the Community Relations Manager; drafting, editing, proofreading; digital and social adaptations	[]
Print and production coordinator	[]	Print specs, quotes, proofs, file handoff, quantities, delivery; QR code and link audit	[]
Social media and e-blast specialist	[]	Monthly content calendar, posts, e-blasts, reshare and engagement	[]

Mark Odom — account lead

- **Education:** B.S. in Marketing, University of Hawaii.
- **Marketing and sales leadership:** CEO and owner of Northwest Ticket & Investment Company since 2001. He built and runs a national sales operation with more than \$20 million in lifetime revenue, including strategic marketing, the full client lifecycle and automated sales systems.
- **Digital systems:** founder of IEBC (2025–present). He builds email and text programs, dashboards, content and document systems, and workflow automation.
- **Senior-level relationships:** executive recruiter at Korn Ferry International (2001–2002), placing CEOs, CFOs and COOs.

- **Detroit:** lives and works in Detroit (48219).

Staff that can be dedicated: [number] people, with backup coverage from the partner firm for peak periods such as newsletter production weeks and large events.

Attachment B — Proposal Introduction and Solution / Approach

B1. Proposal introduction

Integrated Efficiency Business Consultants (IEBC) submits this proposal in response to City of Detroit RFP No. 550575, Media Relation Services, for the City Council office of Councilwoman Johnson, District 4.

- **Firm offer:** this proposal remains firm for 120 days from the due date, and after that until IEBC withdraws it, a contract is executed, or the City ends the procurement, whichever comes first.
- **About IEBC:** a Detroit-based marketing, communications and business-systems firm. We produce clear, on-brand communications in print and digital formats, and we build the processes that get them reviewed, approved and delivered on time. [Add the partner firm and its years of service.]
- **Commitment:** IEBC commits to perform the work in Section 2 of the RFP according to the RFP's requirements, the executed contract, and the rules, regulations and supervision of the City.
- **Licenses and registrations:** [Michigan entity filing / certificate of good standing; City of Detroit supplier registration; CRIO certificates if held.] No professional license is required for these services.

B2. Solution and approach

We act as an extension of the Councilwoman's team. We turn the office's priorities into finished, on-brand pieces for every channel, run the review cycle so staff time goes into content rather than chasing files, and hand print-ready work to vendors on schedule.

Knowing the brand and the district. Before producing anything, we review the office's past newsletters, flyers, social accounts, statements and District 4 programs. We meet the Councilwoman's staff to confirm her priorities, voice and positions [list the 3–4 priorities from her newsletters and Council record], and we write a one-page brand and style guide for approval. Every later piece is checked against it.

What the RFP lists	How we deliver it
District-wide newsletter (multi-page, recurring)	Editorial plan per issue; content gathered from Policy Analysts, Community Liaisons and the Community Relations Manager; writing, design, two proof rounds, print-ready files and mailing handoff
Digital version of the newsletter	Same content adapted for web and email: live hyperlinks instead of QR codes, mobile layout, accessible text
Yearly calendar	District events, Council dates and resident deadlines in one designed calendar, approved by the office in the fall for the next year
Flyers and event handout brochures	Fast-turn templates in the brand: standard turnaround [5] business days, rush [2]
Fridge magnets, table throws, stand-up banners, yard signs, vehicle wraps	Designs to each vendor's exact specs, proofs approved before production, vendor quotes for the office's choice
Social media and e-blast content	Monthly content calendar; posts and e-blasts drafted for approval; reshare strategy for partner and City posts; engagement guidance
PR messaging statements and talking points	Drafted to the office's positions and voice, same-day turnaround for urgent statements, fact-checked before release
Content gathering, drafting, editing, proofreading	One intake form and deadline per piece; two proofreading passes; a style checklist on every file
Review cycles across staff and leadership	One tracked review per piece: named reviewers, due dates, a single consolidated set of edits, and the final approval recorded
Print vendor coordination and handoff	Specs, quantities, quotes, proofs and file handoff managed by us; delivery to the office or the mail house

What the RFP lists	How we deliver it
QR code and hyperlink audit	Every QR code scanned and every link opened on the final proof, and logged, before print
Media campaigns and calls to action	A campaign plan for key moments (budget, town halls, district programs) with a clear call to action, channels and a simple results report
Presence at major district programs	We attend agreed programs, capture photos and quotes for future content, and send the office a short note on what we saw and outreach ideas
Strategic and creative input	Recommendations on layout, brand integration, messaging, process and timelines in each monthly check-in

Brand stewardship across every touchpoint. One brand kit holds the logo, colors, fonts, photo style and tone, with ready templates for each format. Print, signage, promotional items, the digital newsletter and social posts all draw from it, so the office looks and sounds the same everywhere.

B3. Project timeline and schedule

The first newsletter ships within 60 days of the purchase order. After that, work runs on a steady monthly rhythm. Dates count from the purchase order, since work can't begin before it (RFP section 5.3).

Start-up

When	Milestone
Week 1	Kickoff with the office: priorities, reviewers, approval rules, calendar of district programs
Weeks 1–3	Review of past materials; brand and style guide and template kit for approval
Week 3	Social and e-blast content calendar for the first month

When	Milestone
Weeks 4–8	First district newsletter: content intake, draft, design, two proofs, print and mail handoff; digital version
Week 8	First monthly report and check-in

Recurring schedule [match the newsletter frequency to the office's plan]

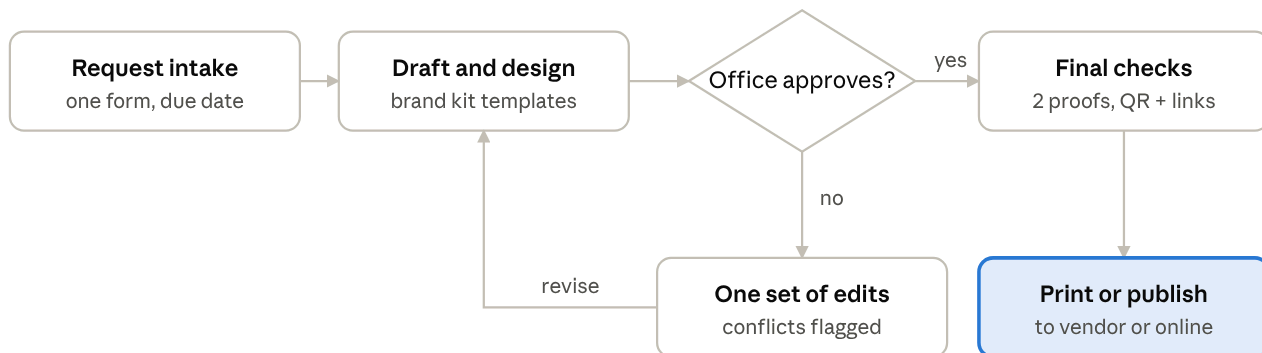
Deliverable	Cadence	Standard turnaround
District newsletter, print and digital	[Quarterly]	4–5 weeks from content deadline to mailing
Social posts and e-blasts	Monthly calendar, weekly posting	Approved 1 week ahead
Flyers and event brochures	As needed	5 business days (rush 2)
PR statements and talking points	As needed	Same day for urgent, 2 days standard
Promotional items and signage	As needed	Design 5 business days; production per vendor
Yearly calendar	Once a year	Approved by November 1 for the next year
Monthly report and check-in	Monthly	First week of the month

B4. Technical approach

Every piece follows the same path from intake to delivery, so nothing goes to print or out by email without the office's approval and a final check of every QR code and link.

Nothing goes out without the office's approval and a QR and link check

How every newsletter, flyer, post and statement is produced



production and review flow · every piece, every channel

Procedures

- 1. Intake.** The office or a staff contributor submits a request on one form: purpose, audience, call to action, deadline and source material. We confirm scope and the due date within one business day.
- 2. Draft and design.** We write and lay out the piece from the brand kit, and adapt it for each channel it needs (print, digital, social).
- 3. One consolidated review.** The draft goes to the named reviewers with a due date. We merge their comments into one set of edits, flag any conflicts for the office to decide, and record final approval.
- 4. Final checks.** Two proofreading passes. Every QR code is scanned and every link opened on the final proof, and print specs and quantities are confirmed.
- 5. Production and delivery.** We hand files to the print vendor and approve its proof, or publish or schedule digital pieces. Delivery is confirmed back to the office.
- 6. Report.** A monthly report covers what was produced, on-time rate, reach and engagement for digital pieces, and recommendations.

Fees and changes: work is billed at the Attachment C rates, and anything outside the agreed scope is quoted before it starts.

City data standards (section 2.3). Our project tracker and content library keep every request, approval, file and result for the office. The City gets:

- Full access to that data in machine-readable form: CSV export and a documented JSON API (field names and objects), with read and update access for City systems.
- The data model documented, and the City free to move, warehouse and reuse its data.

- Access limited to authorized users, encryption in transit and at rest, and no residents' personal information beyond what the office supplies for mailings.

Use of AI (section 5.7, Attachment A item r). AI tools help write first drafts, resize one approved piece for different formats, check spelling and grammar, and find broken links. A trained person on our team edits every AI-assisted draft. Nothing is published or printed without the office's approval. We never put residents' personal or sensitive information into AI tools. On request, we tell the City which tools we use and how.

Attachment C — Pricing

The not-to-exceed price for professional services is **\$212,000 over three years** (\$70,500 a year at the estimated volume below). Rates are firm for the full contract term. Printing, mailing and promotional-item production are billed at the vendor's invoiced cost with no markup, only after the office approves each quote. [Draft figures — confirm against your costs and the partner firm's rates before entering them.]

Hourly rates by staff type

Staff type	Rate per hour
Account lead / strategist	\$125
Senior graphic designer	\$95
Writer / editor	\$85
Social media and e-blast specialist	\$75
Print and production coordinator	\$65
On-site attendance at district programs	\$85

Fixed prices per deliverable (design, writing, editing, two proof rounds, review management, QR and link audit, vendor handoff)

Deliverable	Price	Estimated per year	Annual estimate
District newsletter, up to 8 pages (print-ready)	\$2,800 an issue	4	\$11,200

Deliverable	Price	Estimated per year	Annual estimate
Digital / e-mail version of the newsletter	\$450 an issue	4	\$1,800
Yearly calendar	\$1,800	1	\$1,800
Flyer (one page, print and digital)	\$275	24	\$6,600
Event handout brochure	\$650	6	\$3,900
Promotional item or sign design (magnet, table throw, banner, yard sign)	\$250 a design	8	\$2,000
Vehicle wrap design	\$900	1	\$900
Social media and e-blast package (about 12 posts and 2 e-blasts)	\$1,200 a month	12	\$14,400
PR messaging statement	\$350	12	\$4,200
Talking points / messaging guidance	\$300	12	\$3,600
Strategy, brand stewardship and campaign planning (10 hours a month)	\$1,250 a month	12	\$15,000
On-site attendance at major district programs (about 5 hours a month)	\$85 an hour	60 hours	\$5,100
Total, professional services			\$70,500

Three years at this volume is \$211,500; the not-to-exceed price is rounded to \$212,000. The City pays only for work ordered and delivered, at these rates.

Attachments D1, D2 and E — forms and contract

Upload with the proposal (D1, bid requirements)

- ☐ Certificate of Authority (the LLC or corporation version that matches IEBC's entity type), signed
- ☐ Non-Collusion Affidavit, signed and notarized
- ☐ Affidavit of Disclosure of Interests, signed and notarized
- ☐ CRIO certificates for IEBC and any Detroit subcontractor, for equalization credits

☐ Attachments A, B and C, complete

Due only if awarded (D2, conditions of award): the remaining City forms and affidavits, including the slavery-era, prison-industry and immigration-detention disclosures, and a certificate of insurance meeting the model contract's limits from an insurer registered with Michigan DIFS.

Attachment E — Model Professional Services Contract

IEBC accepts the City of Detroit Model Professional Services Contract (Attachment E) as written. [Or list exceptions here, section by section. Have counsel review the insurance, indemnity and data clauses before signing.]

Signature

Submitted and signed in EUNA Bonfire by an officer authorized to bind IEBC.

Name and title: Mark Odom, Founder & CEO

Company: Integrated Efficiency Business Consultants (IEBC)

Date: []